

Contribution Journal Report for Midterm

Prepared for Prof. Vishwantha Rao, HCC ITAI 1371 Machine Learning

Prepared by FA26_ML_6171_16347 3_ITAI1371 Group

09-Oct-2026

This report was prepared for the MidTerm for ITAI 1371 Machine Learning, by the group FA26_ML_6171_16347 3_ITAI1371.

Members of the group include the following students:

- Carmen Petronila Esono Afang
- Yuanyuan Kou
- Irene “Alex” Ramos
- Eric Roberson
- Xiomara Torres
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Please refer to the ReadMe.MD file at <https://github.com/ericjroberson-HOU/ITAI-1371-ML-Labs> for intellectual property used in all labs for the course.

Thank you for the opportunity to prepare this reflective journal report. Individual contributions follow.

- **Eric Roberson** - Performed each of the following tasks for this lab:
 1. Created folders on OneDrive for upcoming lab.
 2. Sent an announcement to the team regarding deadline to submit assignment and instructions to update to the Reflection & Contribution Journals, and then synced up with Irene “Alex” Ramos to mention the Midterm assignment on GroupMe.
 3. Cowrote a midterm proposal, got consensus from team, and submitted proposal on GitHub on 18-Sep-2026. Revised the proposal based on multiple rounds of feedback from Prof. Rao with the final proposal completed on 30-Sep-2026. Uploaded the revised proposal to GitHub.
 4. Worked on .IPYNB file for the lab. Asked Alex to QA my work.
 5. Updated the contribution and reflection journals with my own input.
 6. Took responsibility for converting the files on OneDrive and uploading the .PDF files to GitHub before 11PM on the due date.
 7. Synced up with Irene “Alex” Ramos about submitting the final assignment. Asked Alex to perform a QA of everything on GitHub.
- Carmen Petronila Esono Afang

- 1. Reviewed the group proposal to align project goals, required features, and submission guidelines.
- 2. Analyzed the dataset structure in Python to identify missing values and plan necessary cleaning steps.
- 3. Studied target label creation and confirmed removing rating to prevent data leakage.
- 4. Checked that all feature transformations (imputation, scaling, encoding) stay strictly within the training set.
- 5. Drafted personal reflection and contribution entries for group submission.

- Yuanyuan Kou

1. Reviewed our group's proposal to understand the project goal and planned features.
2. Read the instructor's requirements and compared them with our project plan.
3. Reviewed the draft notebook to better understand the data preparation steps.
4. Identified points that need checking, including the order of EDA, keeping the test set untouched, and matching the notebook's features with the proposal.
5. Studied how movie ratings create the kid_safe label and why rating must be removed from the model inputs.
6. Prepared my personal reflection and contribution entries.

- Irene "Alex" Ramos

1. Revised midterm proposal
2. Worked with Eric on project ideas, needs, data points, objectives
3. Created a poll to ensure group agreement on midterm subject
4. Checked poll results
5. Submitted midterm proposal docx so that it is editable and viewable by group
6. Notified team about next steps to complete project

- Xiomara Torres

- Reviewed midterm proposal & project requirements
- Reviewed Netflix dataset
- Reviewed our groups Colab notebook and data preprocessing steps, including data cleaning, handling missing values and preparing the dataset for machine learning.
- Prepared individual reflection and contribution journal entries for final group submission.

This concludes our contribution journal for ITAI 1371 ML MidTerm, which was uploaded to [GitHub](#) on 09-Oct-2026.